

BUDGET COMMITTEE MEETING – Wednesday May 6, 2026

1:30 p.m. – Anne Basker Auditorium

600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Budget Committee: Ron Smith(absent), Colene Martin, and Gary Richardson, Marc Kirby, Chris Collins and Dorothy Yetter; Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Budget Officer: Ruth Nelson, Finance Director

1) Open Meeting – Colene Martin, Vice-Chair, Board of County Commissioners

Commissioner Martin opened the meeting at 9:00 a.m.

2) Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

All members declared that there is not a conflict of interest on today's agenda.

3) Establish new Chair and Vice-Chair for the Budget Committee

Ms. Martin opened the floor for nominations to fill the Chair and Vice-Chair positions for the new board. Colene Martin made a motion to elect Gary Richardson as Chair of the Budget Committee, seconded by Dorothy Yetter. Upon Roll Call- Ms. Yetter – Yes, Mr. Collins – Yes, Mr. Kirby –Yes, Mr. Richardson – Yes, Ms. Martin – Yes. Motion carried 5-0.

Gary Richardson made a motion to elect Marc Kirby as Vice-Chair of the Budget Committee, seconded by Colene Martin. Upon Roll Call- Ms. Yetter – Yes, Mr. Collins – Yes, Mr. Kirby –Yes, Mr. Richardson – Yes, Ms. Martin – Yes. Motion carried 5-0.

4) Budget Officer presents the Fiscal Year 2025-26 Supplemental Budget

Ruth Nelson, Budget Officer and Finance Director, presented the Fiscal Year 2025–2026 Supplemental Budget materials to the Budget Committee. Nelson explained that supplemental budgets are used to amend appropriations after adoption of the annual budget when unexpected circumstances arise or when new appropriations or transfers become necessary. She further explained that while Oregon budget law does not require Budget Committee approval for supplemental budgets, Josephine County Charter requires Budget Committee review and approval.

Nelson reviewed Exhibit A and Exhibit B contained within the budget packet and explained that the supplemental budget before the Committee primarily addressed reinstatement of the County's Solid Waste Program under the Public Health Department.

Nelson stated that the proposed supplemental budget would:

- Transfer \$31,000 from the General Fund
- Reinstatement one FTE position for the remainder of Fiscal Year 2025–2026
- Cover approximately two months of operating expenses through June 30, 2026

She further explained that the estimated annual cost of the program is approximately \$176,000, including personnel and materials and services. Nelson clarified that the County is currently applying for a Solid Waste Agency grant expected to provide approximately \$155,000 annually beginning July 1, 2026, if approved.

Nelson additionally clarified discussion from the prior Board meeting, confirming that the proposed grant amount would be \$155,000 per year rather than a total amount spread across multiple years. Chair Richardson and Commissioner Martin provided additional background regarding the County's decision to return solid waste enforcement responsibilities to the Public Health Department. Discussion focused on distinctions between public health enforcement matters and traditional code enforcement or building code violations handled through Community Development.

Commissioners explained that the reinstated position would primarily address environmental and public health-related complaints, including:

- Sewage discharge issues
- Trash accumulation creating health hazards
- Disease vector concerns such as rodent infestations
- Conditions impacting neighboring properties or waterways

Commissioners emphasized that the position would not focus on building code enforcement, land use violations, or general construction compliance matters.

Discussion also occurred regarding public perception of prior enforcement structures and concerns previously expressed by members of the community regarding consolidation of enforcement authority within Community Development. Commissioners noted the importance of clearly separating environmental public health enforcement from land use and building code enforcement responsibilities.

5) Public Comment *(limit of three minutes each)*

No public testimony was provided.

6) Deliberate on Supplemental Budget

Budget Committee members discussed the supplemental budget and asked questions regarding the history and future operation of the Solid Waste Program.

Chris Collins asked why the position had previously been removed and whether reinstating the position would result in future staffing concerns or backlash. Commissioners discussed historical concerns related to property rights perceptions and prior organizational changes that consolidated certain enforcement activities into Community Development.

Committee members additionally discussed:

- Existing backlog of complaints
- Whether one employee would be sufficient to address enforcement demands
- Potential future administrative support needs
- Differences between environmental health enforcement and building code enforcement
- The need for improved complaint routing systems within County operations and the County website

Commissioners noted that the prior Solid Waste Program had historically involved more than one staff member and acknowledged that future staffing needs may need to be evaluated during the upcoming annual budget process.

Discussion also occurred regarding the County's supplemental budget process generally, with Nelson explaining that this represented the third supplemental budget hearing of the fiscal year, with one additional supplemental budget expected before the close of Fiscal Year 2025–2026.

7) Motion to Approve Supplemental Budget

Chris Collins made a motion to approve the Fiscal Year 2025–2026 Supplemental Budget as presented, seconded by Dorothy Yetter. Upon Roll Call- Ms. Yetter – Yes, Mr. Collins – Yes, Mr. Kirby –Abstained, Mr. Richardson – Yes, Ms. Martin – Yes. Motion carried 4-1.

8) Adjourn

The meeting adjourned at 1:53 p.m.

Exhibit 1 – Budget Message FY 2026



Finance Department
(541) 474-5255
500 NW 6th Street
Grants Pass, OR 97526
www.josephinecounty.gov

May 5, 2026

TO: The Citizens of Josephine County and Budget Committee Members

FR: Ruth Nelson, Finance Director/Budget Officer

RE: Supplemental Budget for FY 2025-26 – Solid Waste

When the budget is adopted by the Board of County Commissioners it sets the legal expenditure limitations by appropriation. These limitations are detailed in the appropriation resolution. When unexpected circumstances arise, appropriations may need to be increased or decreased, transferred from one appropriation category to another, or new appropriation categories created. Supplemental budgets are the method used to amend the budget after the budget is adopted.

Per Oregon budget law the budget committee is not required to approve supplemental budgets, but it is required per the County charter. The Budget Committee is scheduled to review and approve the supplemental budget Wednesday May 6, 2026, at 1:30 PM in the Anne Basker Auditorium as noticed in the Daily Courier and on the Josephine County website. The opportunity for public testimony on the proposed supplemental budget will be provided at this meeting. Citizens are also encouraged to submit comments in writing, either by mail to the Board of County Commissioners Office or by email to bcc@josephinecounty.gov.

Two exhibits follow this memo. Exhibit A (page 2) shows the new appropriations as required by Oregon Budget Law for any appropriations with a change. You will also see a brief description of the reason for the change. Exhibit B (page 3) shows the originally adopted appropriations for the entire County budget, the changes to the appropriation, and the new appropriation. Below is a summary of the changes:

- The Board of County Commissioners agreed to bring back the Solid Waste Department under Public Health. This Supplemental Budget is to reinstate Solid Waste operations before the end of FY 2026. This is funded by a \$31,000 transfer from the General Fund and covers the cost of the program for just the remaining two months of the fiscal year.
- The annual cost of the program is estimated to be \$176K for FY 2027 including personnel costs as well as materials and services. The County is in the process of applying for a grant from the Solid Waste Agency in the amount of \$155K for future years minimizing the use of General Funds.

The total increase to the FY 2026 County budget for this supplemental only is \$31,000 and 1 FTE. Once the supplemental budget is approved by the Budget Committee it goes to the Board of County Commissioners for adoption. The supplemental budget hearing is tentatively scheduled for May 13, 2026 at 9:00 AM with the opportunity for public testimony.

EXHIBIT A - SUMMARY OF SUPPLEMENTAL BUDGET FY 2026

FUND: General Fund (10)

Resource	Amount	Expenditures	Amount
		Interfund Transfer Out	\$8,402,400
		Contingency	\$1,023,300
Revised Total Resources	\$17,491,400	Revised Total Requirements	\$17,491,400

Comments:

Added an Interfund Transfer Out from General Fund (10) to Public Health Fund (14) in the amount of \$31,000.

FUND: Public Health Fund (14)

Resource	Amount	Expenditures	Amount
Interfund Transfer In	\$31,000	Public Health	\$3,018,100
Revised Total Resources	\$3,309,900	Revised Total Requirements	\$3,309,900
FTE	21.40	FTE	22.40

Comments:

The Board of County Commissioners agreed to bring back the Solid Waste Department under Public Health. This Supplemental Budget is to reinstate Solid Waste operations before the end of the 25/26 Fiscal Year. This is funded by a \$31,000 transfer from the General Fund and covers the cost of the program for just the remaining two months of the fiscal year.

EXHIBIT B - SUPPLEMENTAL BUDGET FY 2026

FUNDS/PROGRAM CLASSIFICATIONS	ORIGINAL APPROPRIATION	ORIGINAL	1st Supplemental		2nd Supplemental		3rd Supplemental		NEW APPROPRIATION	NEW FTE
			APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE		
10 - General Fund:										
Assessor's Office	1,800,600	16.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,800,600	16.00
Clerk's Office	873,700	4.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	873,700	4.00
Treasurer's Office	615,100	4.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	615,100	4.00
Surveyor's Office	125,500	1.13	-	-	-	-	-	-	125,500	1.13
Veteran's Service Office	448,000	3.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	448,000	3.00
General Government	444,400	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	444,400	-
Court Facilities	617,400	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	617,400	-
Emergency Management	394,100	2.00	-	-	330,000	1.00	-	-	724,100	3.00
Forestry	1,722,300	6.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,722,300	6.00
Community Development / Planning	644,600	4.50	-	-	50,000	2.00	-	-	694,600	6.50
Nondepartmental:										
Interfund Transfers	8,303,400		68,000		-		31,000		8,402,400	
Operating Contingency	1,172,300		(68,000)		(50,000)		(31,000)		1,023,300	
Total General Fund	17,161,400	40.63	-	-	330,000	3.00	-	-	17,491,400	43.63
11 - Public Works Fund:										
Public Works	9,411,400	57.20	-	-	-	-	-	-	9,411,400	57.20
Interfund Transfers	3,047,100		-		-		-		3,047,100	
Contingency	1,411,700		-		-		-		1,411,700	
Total Public Works Fund	13,870,200	57.20	-	-	-	-	-	-	13,870,200	57.20
12 - Law Enforcement Fund										
Sheriff's Office	3,631,100	20.75	-	-	-	-	-	-	3,631,100	20.75
Patrol, Dispatch, & Evidence	6,607,200	35.75	21,600	-	-	-	-	-	6,628,800	35.75
District Attorney's Office	3,873,300	25.60	68,000	1.00	-	-	-	-	3,941,300	26.60
Juvenile Justice	1,719,600	12.12	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,719,600	12.12
Nondepartmental:										
Interfund Transfers	1,714,100								1,714,100	-
Total Law Enforcement Fund	17,545,300	94.22	89,600	1.00	-	-	-	-	17,634,900	95.22
13 - Community Corrections Fund:										
Community Corrections	6,569,800	34.90	-	-	-	-	-	-	6,569,800	34.90
Interfund Transfers	2,115,200		-		-		-		2,115,200	-
Contingency	1,207,200		-		-		-		1,207,200	-
Total Community Corrections Fund	9,892,200	34.90	-	-	-	-	-	-	9,892,200	34.90
15 - Mental Health Fund:										
Mental Health	7,478,500	7.00	65,000	1.00	-	-	-	-	7,543,500	8.00
Interfund Transfers	113,200		-		-		-		113,200	-
Contingency	1,043,300		-		-		-		1,043,300	-
Total Mental Health Fund	8,635,000	7.00	65,000	1.00	-	-	-	-	8,700,000	8.00
17 - Jail & Detention Fund										
Sheriff - Adult Jail	9,420,200	44.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	9,420,200	44.00
Juvenile Justice - Detention	2,683,300	19.38	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,683,300	19.38
Nondepartmental:										
Interfund Transfers	1,212,400		22,300		-		-		1,234,700	-
Contingency	580,000		(22,300)		-		-		557,700	-
Total Jail & Detention Fund	13,895,900	63.38	-	-	-	-	-	-	13,895,900	63.38
49 - Forestry Reserve Fund:										
Forestry Reserve Program	202,000		-		-		-		202,000	
Interfund Transfers	53,600		-		-		-		53,600	
Contingency	30,300		-		-		-		30,300	
Fund Total	285,900	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	285,900	-

FUNDS/PROGRAM CLASSIFICATIONS	ORIGINAL APPROPRIATION	ORIGINAL	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	NEW APPROPRIATION	NEW FTE
Internal Service Funds:										
40 - Administrative Internal Service Fund										
Board of County Commissioners	647,800	5.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	647,800	5.00
Finance	1,391,600	8.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,391,600	8.00
Information Technology	2,526,700	9.92	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,526,700	9.92
Geographical Information Systems	201,300	1.08	-	-	-	-	-	-	201,300	1.08
Human Resources	646,200	3.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	646,200	3.00
Legal Counsel	800,300	3.67	-	-	-	-	-	-	800,300	3.67
Law Library	83,800	0.53	-	-	-	-	-	-	83,800	0.53
Property Management	266,000	1.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	266,000	1.00
Nondepartmental:										
Fund Level Program	160,100		100,000		-		-		260,100	
Interfund Transfers	505,500		-		-		-		505,500	
Contingency	928,300		(100,000)		-		-		828,300	
Fund Total	8,157,600	32.20	-	-	-	-	-	-	8,157,600	32.20
41 - County Facilities and Fleet Fund										
Facilities Services	3,536,500	18.00	-	-	20,000	1.00	-	-	3,556,500	19.00
County Fleet	1,352,200	4.80	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,352,200	4.80
Nondepartmental:										
Interfund Transfers	975,400		-	-	-	-	-	-	975,400	
Contingency	444,400		-	-	(20,000)	-	-	-	424,400	
Fund Total	6,308,500	22.80	-	-	-	1.00	-	-	6,308,500	23.80
Total Internal Service Funds	14,466,100	55.00	-	-	-	1.00	-	-	14,466,100	56.00
Special Revenue Funds:										
14 - Public Health Fund										
Public Health	2,987,100	21.40	-	-	-	-	31,000	1.00	3,018,100	22.40
Interfund Transfers	246,800		-		-		-		246,800	
Contingency	45,000		-		-		-		45,000	
Fund Total	3,278,900	21.40	-	-	-	-	31,000	1.00	3,309,900	22.40
16 - Grant Projects Fund										
Community Development Block Grant (CDBG)	480,000		-		-		-		480,000	
Economic Development	740,000		-		-		-		740,000	
American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA)	160,400		-		-		-		160,400	
Interfund Transfers	530,800		-		90,000		-		620,800	
Contingency	328,500		-		(90,000)		-		238,500	
Fund Total	2,239,700	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,239,700	-
20 - Building and Safety Fund										
Community Development / Building Safety	923,700	5.50	-	-	-	-	-	-	923,700	5.50
Interfund Transfers	92,400		-		-		-		92,400	
Contingency	139,400		-		-		-		139,400	
Fund Total	1,155,500	5.50	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,155,500	5.50
22 - Court Security Fund										
Court Security	69,900		-		-		-		69,900	
Contingency	10,500		-		-		-		10,500	
Fund Total	80,400	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	80,400	-
26 - Animal Shelter & Control Fund										
Animal Shelter - Public Health	923,300	7.45	-	-	-	-	-	-	923,300	7.45
Animal Control - Sheriff	455,400	3.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	455,400	3.00
Nondepartmental:										
Interfund Transfers	147,800		-		-		-		147,800	
Contingency	108,900		-		-		-		108,900	
Fund Total	1,635,400	10.45	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,635,400	10.45
30 - County Clerk Records Fund										
County Clerk Records	13,700		-		-		-		13,700	
Interfund Transfers	1,400		-		-		-		1,400	
Contingency	2,000		-		-		-		2,000	
Fund Total	17,100	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	17,100	-

FUNDS/PROGRAM CLASSIFICATIONS	ORIGINAL APPROPRIATION	ORIGINAL	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	NEW APPROPRIATION	NEW FTE
32 - District Attorney Special Programs Fund										
DA Special Programs	64,400		-		-		-		64,400	
Interfund Transfers	65,600		-		-		-		65,600	
Fund Total	130,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	130,000	-
33 - Juvenile Justice Special Programs Fund										
Juvenile Justice Special Programs	184,300	4.30	-	-	-	-	-	-	184,300	4.30
Interfund Transfers	18,400		-		-		-		18,400	
Contingency	33,000		-		-		-		33,000	
Fund Total	235,700	4.30	-	-	-	-	-	-	235,700	4.30
34 - Public Land Corner Preservation Fund										
Public Land Corner	140,400	1.14	-	-	-	-	-	-	140,400	1.14
Interfund Transfers	14,000		-		-		-		14,000	
Fund Total	154,400	1.14	-	-	-	-	-	-	154,400	1.14
35 - Public Works Special Programs Fund										
North Valley Industrial Park	71,200		-		-		-		71,200	
Solid Waste Landfill Monitoring	67,000		-		-		-		67,000	
Interfund Transfers	27,200		-		-		-		27,200	
Contingency	41,600		-		-		-		41,600	
Fund Total	207,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	207,000	-
71 - County School Reserve Fund										
County School Trust Program	219,000		-		-		-		219,000	
Fund Total	219,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	219,000	-
75 - PEG Access Fund										
PEG Access Program	46,900		-		-		-		46,900	
Fund Total	46,900	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	46,900	-
76 - Sheriff Forfeiture Fund										
Sheriff Forfeiture	163,400		-		-		-		163,400	
Contingency	15,000		-		-		-		15,000	
Fund Total	178,400	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	178,400	-
77 - Sheriff Programs Reserve Fund										
Sheriff Special Programs	19,800		-		-		-		19,800	
Contingency	3,700		-		-		-		3,700	
Fund Total	23,500	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	23,500	-
Total Special Revenue Funds	9,601,900	42.79	-	-	-	-	31,000	1.00	9,632,900	43.79
Enterprise Funds:										
24 - Recreation										
Parks	1,817,400	10.65	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,817,400	10.65
Fairgrounds	995,600	2.10	-	-	-	-	-	-	995,600	2.10
Interfund Transfers	283,700		-		-		-		283,700	
Contingency	337,800		-		-		-		337,800	
Fund Total	3,434,500	12.75	-	-	-	-	-	-	3,434,500	12.75
25 - Transit Fund										
Transit	3,954,400	28.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	3,954,400	28.00
Interfund Transfers	407,100		-		-		-		407,100	
Contingency	219,900		-		-		-		219,900	
Fund Total	4,581,400	28.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	4,581,400	28.00
50 - Jail Commissary Fund										
Jail Commissary	111,000		-		-		-		111,000	
Contingency	20,000		-		-		-		20,000	
Fund Total	131,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	131,000	-
51/52 - Airports Fund										
Grants Pass & Illinois Valley Airports Programs	967,400	3.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	967,400	3.00
Interfund Transfers	105,600		104,800		-		-		210,400	
Contingency	286,100		(104,800)		-		-		181,300	
Fund Total	1,359,100	3.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,359,100	3.00

FUNDS/PROGRAM CLASSIFICATIONS	ORIGINAL APPROPRIATION	ORIGINAL	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	APPROPRIATION CHANGE	FTE CHANGE	NEW APPROPRIATION	NEW FTE
53 - Airports Capital Fund										
Grants Pass & Illinois Valley Airports Capital	4,654,600		890,000		-		-		5,544,600	
Contingency	150,700		-		-		-		150,700	
Fund Total	4,805,300	-	890,000	-	-	-	-	-	5,695,300	-
54 - Fairgrounds Permanent Fund										
Fairgrounds Permanent Fund	-		-		-		-		-	
Interfund Transfers	-		250,000		-		-		250,000	
Contingency	140,000		-		-		-		140,000	
Fund Total	140,000	-	250,000	-	-	-	-	-	390,000	-
Total Enterprise Funds	14,451,300	43.75	1,140,000	-	-	-	-	-	15,591,300	43.75
Reserve Funds:										
42 - Insurance Reserve Fund										
Insurance	1,684,700		-		160,000		-		1,844,700	
Interfund Transfers	50,000		-		-		-		50,000	
Contingency	543,000		-		(160,000)		-		383,000	
Fund Total	2,277,700	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,277,700	-
43 - Payroll Liability Reserve Fund										
Payroll Liability	865,000		-		-		-		865,000	
Fund Total	865,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	865,000	-
46 - Roads and Bridges Reserve Fund										
Road and Bridge Reserve Capital Program	2,789,200		-		-		-		2,789,200	
Contingency	418,400		-		-		-		418,400	
Fund Total	3,207,600	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	3,207,600	-
47 - Property Reserve Fund										
Property Reserve Capital Program	7,726,800		250,000		-		-		7,976,800	
Debt Service	76,000		-		-		-		76,000	
Contingency	968,500		-		-		-		968,500	
Fund Total	8,771,300	-	250,000	-	-	-	-	-	9,021,300	-
48 - Equipment Reserve Fund										
Equipment Reserve Capital Program	2,278,600		31,800		-		-		2,310,400	
Contingency	914,400		(9,500)		-		-		904,900	
Fund Total	3,193,000	-	22,300	-	-	-	-	-	3,215,300	-
Total Reserve Funds	18,314,600	-	272,300	-	-	-	-	-	18,586,900	-
TOTAL APPROPRIATIONS	138,119,800	438.87	1,566,900	2.00	330,000	4.00	31,000	1.00	140,047,700	445.87
***Unappropriated Ending Fund Balances:										
Total Unappropriated and Reserve Amounts, All Funds	44,254,200		(165,200)		(240,000)		-		43,849,000	
Total Unappropriated Ending Fund Balances	44,254,200	-	(165,200)	-	(240,000)	-	-	-	43,849,000	-
GRAND TOTAL ALL FUNDS	182,374,000	438.87	1,401,700	2.00	90,000	4.00	31,000	1.00	183,896,700	445.87